

Problem statement: -2

Title: **Building Word-of-Mouth (WOM) Advocacy for a Brand in a Competitive Market**

In today's highly saturated and digitally driven markets, traditional paid advertising is becoming increasingly expensive and less trusted by consumers. Brands across industries are witnessing a shift in which peer recommendations, user experiences, and community-driven conversations play a significantly more influential role in purchase decisions than direct brand messaging. Achieving a strong **word-of-mouth (WOM) presence** has therefore become a critical growth lever, especially for brands operating in competitive or emerging spaces.

Problem Statement

The challenge is to **design and validate a structured strategy to achieve sustainable word-of-mouth visibility and advocacy for a brand**, such that customers organically recommend the brand through personal networks, online communities, and social platforms.

The problem requires identifying **how brands in the same or similar space have successfully generated WOM in real-world scenarios**, and translating those learnings into **replicable strategies, channels, and engagement models** suitable for the target brand.

Expected Outcome

A clearly defined **word-of-mouth growth blueprint** that outlines proven strategies, key channels, and execution methods, supported by real-world brand references. The outcome should enable the brand to organically increase trust, visibility, and customer acquisition through authentic customer advocacy rather than paid promotion.

Cash prize: -5 K

Time line

1. Submissions of the Final report and presentations of IDP on 10/01/2025)

On mail id ts.ta@stumarj.ictmumbai.edu.in, before 22:00, subject of mail should be "Problem statement" final report submission by "team name"

Example: - **Recovery of Organic Solvents from Saline and Acidic Pharmaceutical Effluent, final report submission by Team AAKRITI**

